2026 IFI Fatherhood Essay Contest

Illinois Fatherhood Initiative

Deadline:
March 19

Student's Name / Nombre del Estudiante-alexis v

Grade / Grado-5

Father/Father-Figure Name / Nombre del Padre/Figura Paterna-romualdo vazquez

School / Escuela -rachel carson

Email Phone / Teléfono

"What my father or an important father-figure* means to me" "Lo que mi padre o una figura paterna importante* significa para mí"

My father figure enters and always whistles the same song,and he always smells like food and grease. I'm always eating the food that he brings me since it's special to me,for example he makes me chicken,and salmon. He makes salads,salmon,steak,and chicken.When he cooks he tries his best to decorate the plates with all his creativity and love.I can learn to always try my best to perfect something from him.

He shows up everyday with a smile going to work, and when coming back he always brings us food custom made from him,and he takes us to the store to get some snacks.

To me my father figure stands out from other dads since for example he tries his best to make us laugh when we are sad, or he will help and support us any time we need. without my father i would not be able to cook like I do now or draw the same,since he supports me even in hard moments.

My perspective changed ever since my dad started to help me and to me this means alot this is why I will forever cherish and love him and I will never stop caring for him like he never stopped caring for me. te quiero i love you